4/6

Book Title: Portable Magic **Name:** Neel Jaiswal **Block:** 2

PETAL Paragraph Strategy for Rhetorical Analysis

Point: Focus on an idea, not a device.	The idea Smith develops is that books shape meaning through their physical presence, and not just through the words printed inside them.
Evidence: Embed quotes seamlessly.	Smith reinforces this idea when she argues that "a book's magic always inheres in its form as much as its content," a claim that foregrounds the physical object before the reader even encounters the words.
Technique: Name the rhetorical device. So ... tone	Smith employs materiality as a rhetorical part of her tone, ~~deliberately~~ foregrounding the physical book itself as a guide for the reader's interpretation.
Analysis/Effect: This is the meat. Why did the author choose *this* technique and not another? What effect does the technique have on the reader? Tone is great - but it should be qualified with an attitude word.	By emphasizing materiality, Smith demonstrates that the physical book shapes the reader's mindset before they start reading. Its weight, texture, and design set expectations and emotional tone, so the reader is already being guided in how they'll understand the text before reaching the first sentence. This early influence reveals the book's agency: its form directs attention, shapes interpretation, and creates a more direct and connected relationship between reader and text. By presenting the book as an active participant rather than a neutral container, Smith reframes reading as a physical and sensory experience shaped by the object itself.
Link: Tie back to the thesis and the guiding question.	Ultimately, this emphasis on materiality enforces Smith's broader claim that books and readers exist in a reciprocal relationship, where the physical form of the book actively shapes interpretation and deepens the reader's engagement with its meaning.

NO THESIS?